TaxAct®

DESIGN THINKING COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

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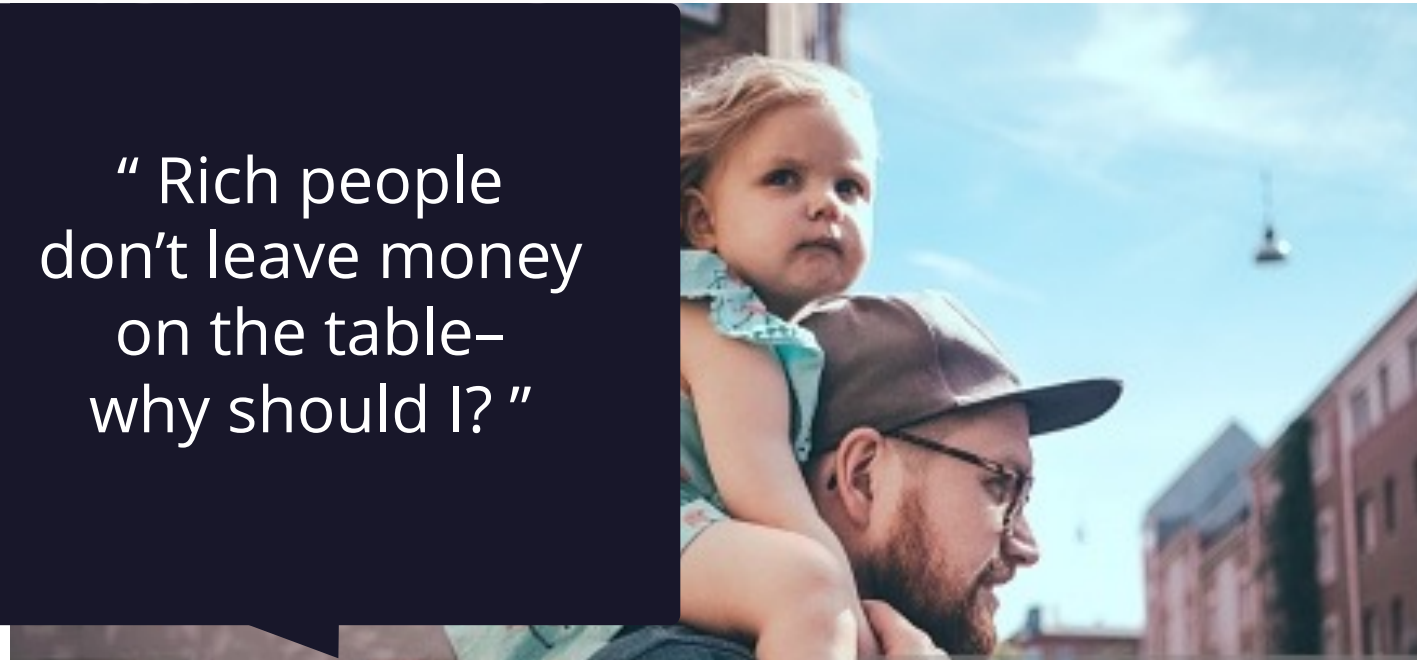
GOAL

DESIGN THINKING COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

We combined a collaborative problem-solving methodology with an assessment of our competitor's strengths and weaknesses. We wanted to better understand our competitors tax experiences, challenge assumptions, redefine problems to identify alternative product strategies along with solutions that might benefit our customers.

PROCESS

AVERAGE CUSTOMER



- 44 years old
- AGI ($53,749)
- Married Filing Jointly (Single income)
- W-2 (1 W-2)
- Receives Refund
- Homeowner
- Mortgage interest ($64,827 Principal)
- Standard deduction
- 2 Children
- Potential SKU Deluxe

COMPETITORS

Best software for ease of use.

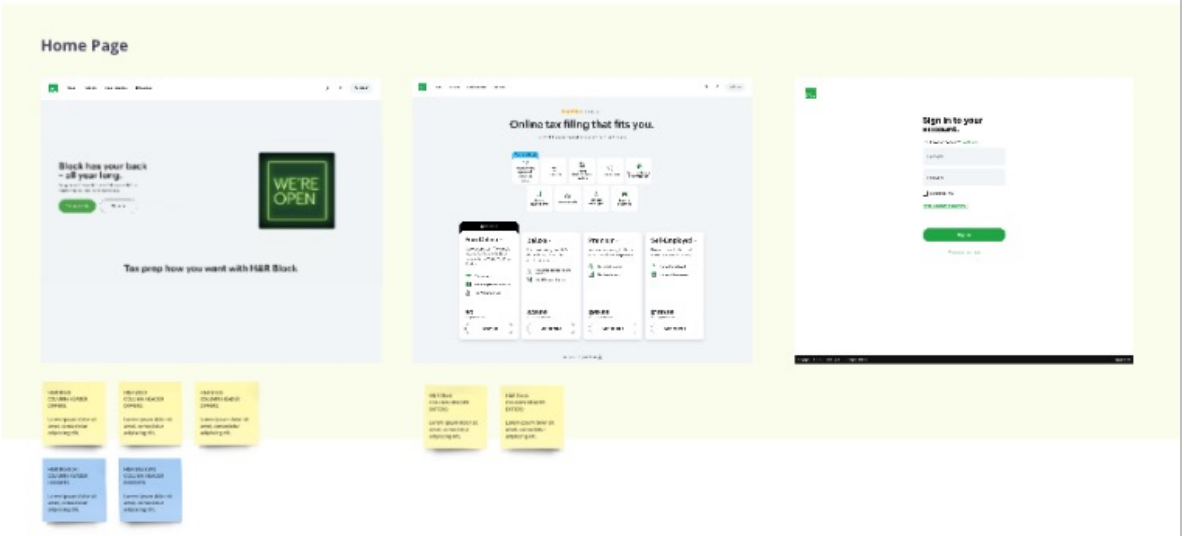
Best software for simple returns.

Best software for customer support.

ANALYSIS

1. Align competitor experiences and note how they differ from TaxAct.
2. Capture insights and align on the most important.
3. Build on ideas and vote on them.
4. Identify opportunities and TaxAct TY21 goals.
5. Prioritize opportunities
6. Identify companies who've solved similar challenges for inspiration.

HRB



Turbo

ANALYSIS

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TurboTax (H)
Basic Info
INSIGHT:

TT nudges the user to keep going with confidence "This helps us with your filing status..)

HRB (H)
Price Transparency
INSIGHT:

H&R Block price widget drops down when there is a change in fee owed.

TaxSlayer (H)
Deductions
INSIGHT:

After inactivity, an offer to upgrade to assisted displayed. It felt like they really wanted to help me as if I was confused.

TaxAct (H)
Basic Info
INSIGHT:

We pitch an upsell before users answer one question about their taxes. Users could see this as a money grab vs being helpful.

ANALYSIS

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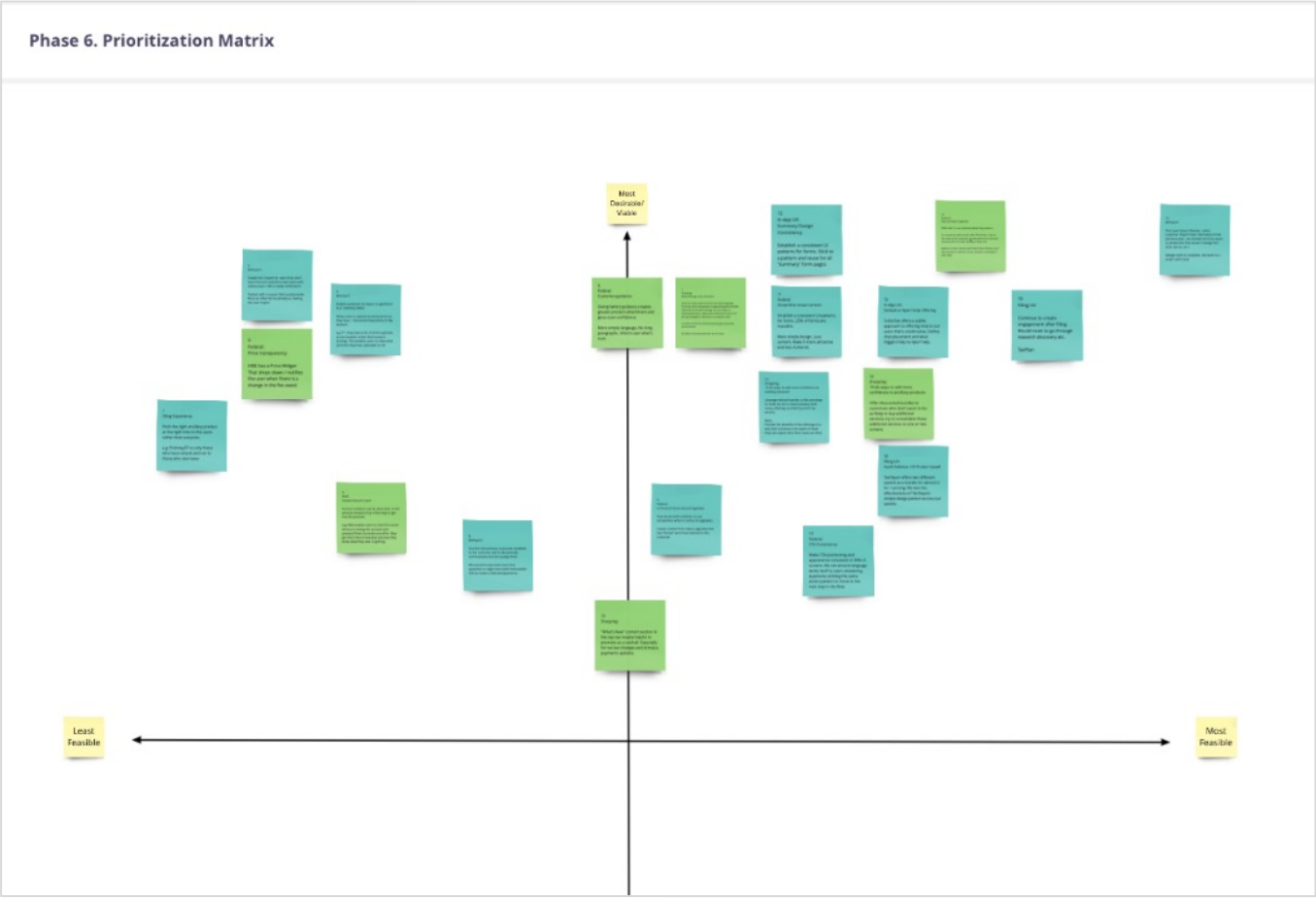
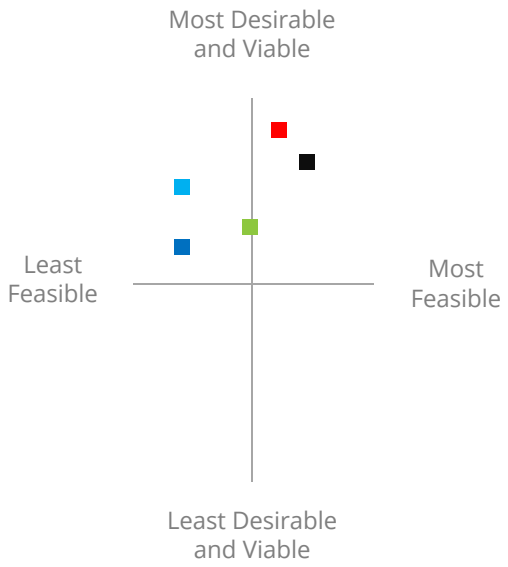


OPPORTUNITIES

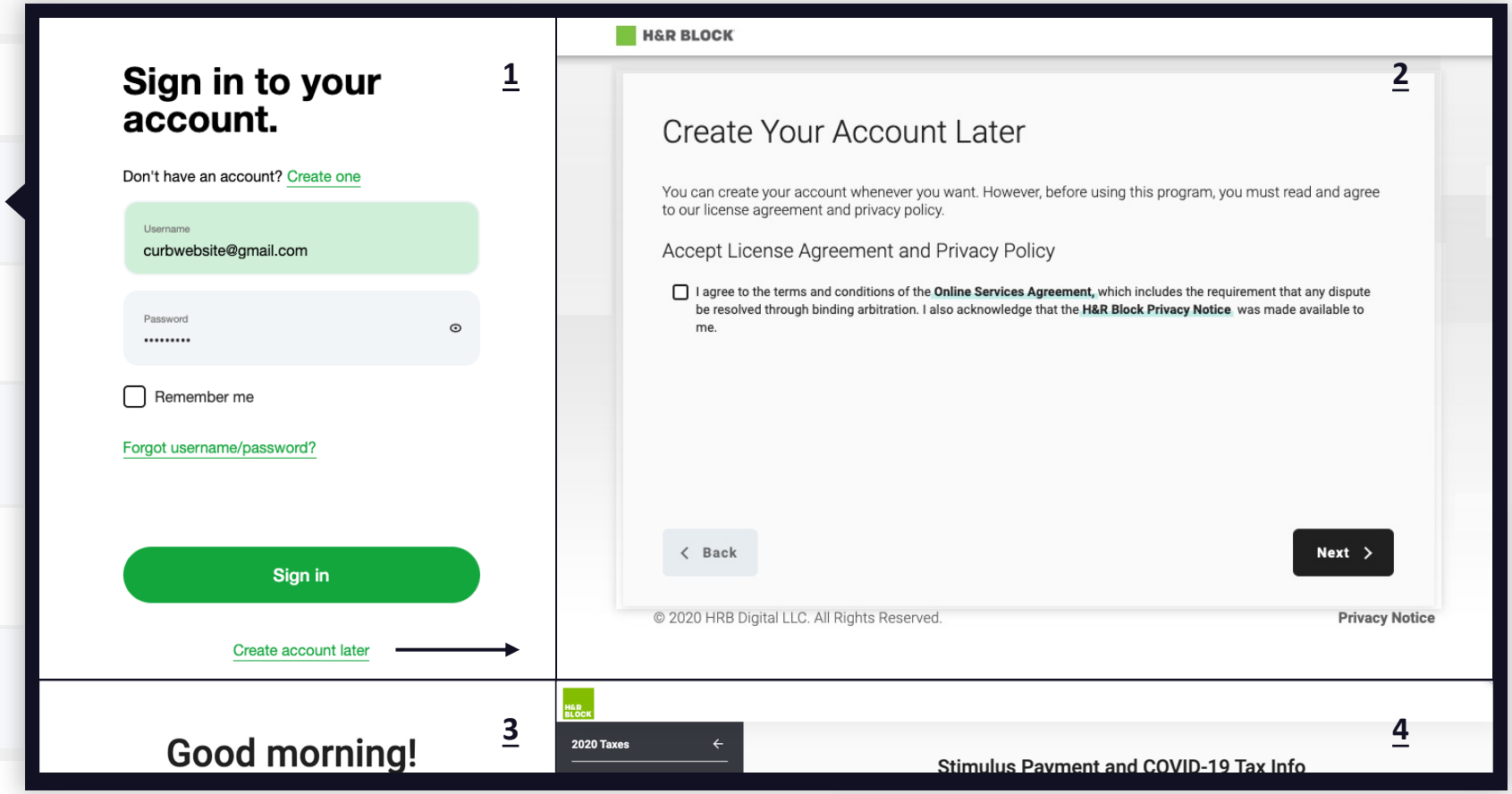
SHOPPING

FOCUS	OPPORTUNITY	PRIORTIZATION MATRIX
Create account later	With HRB allows user to create an account later. Account creation can be less of a barrier if users could start filing process first.	
Attractive offerings	Be more transparent in explaining the benefits our products and inform users of price changes so they aren't surprised later.	
Ancillary products	Add Audit Defense, E-File Concierge to the homepage along with the benefits of the offerings to build confidence in the support we offer.	
What's New	Create a what's new content section that can be accessed from the top nav. Ex: Tax law changes, stimulus payments updates etc.	
Product Picker	Create an experience that allow the user to select certain features à la carte then tell them which product SKU suits them and why.	

SHOPPING

FOCUS

- Create account later
- Attractive offerings
- Ancillary products
- What's New
- Product Picker



SHOPPING

FOCUS

- Create account later
- Attractive offerings
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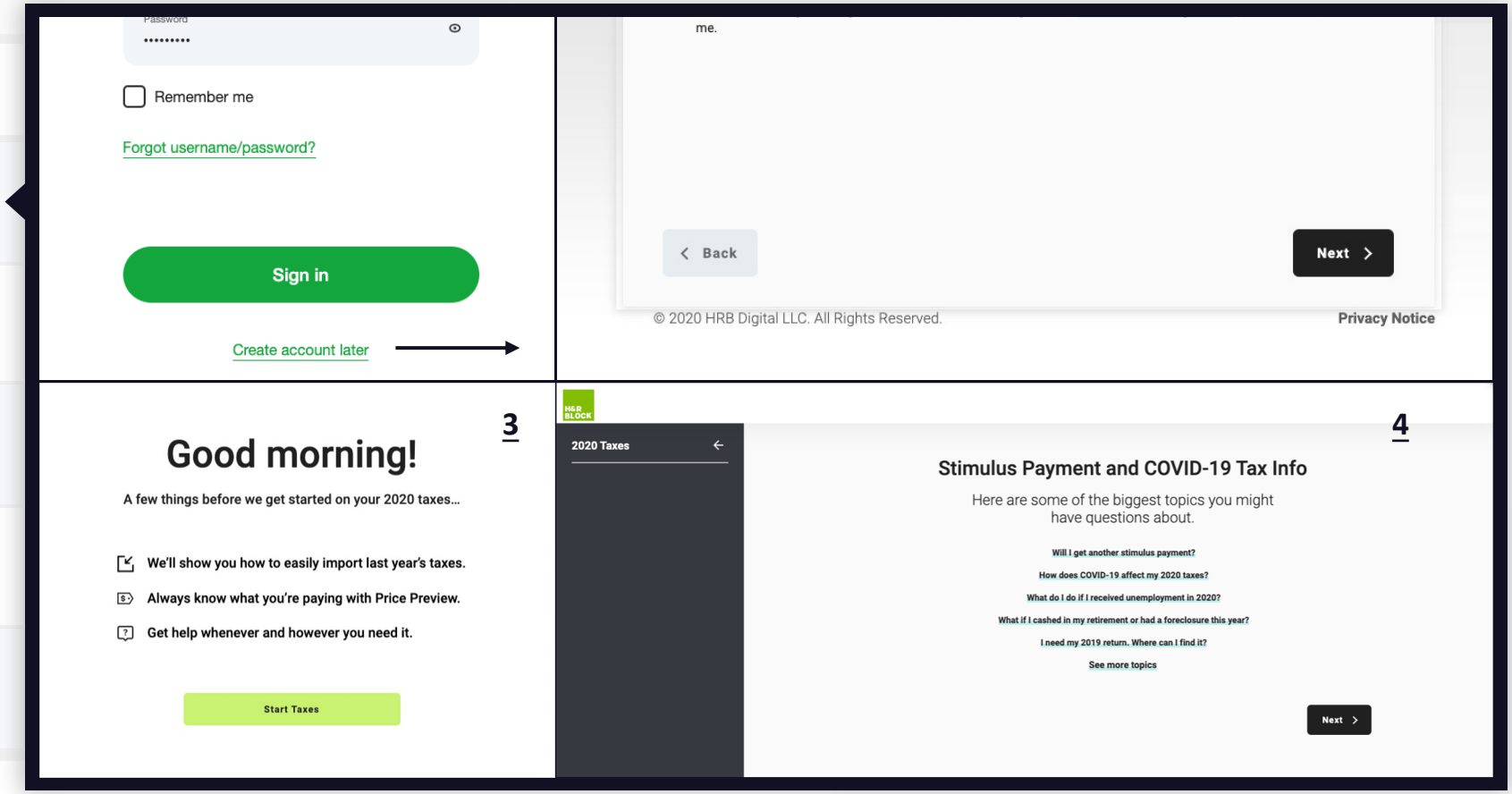
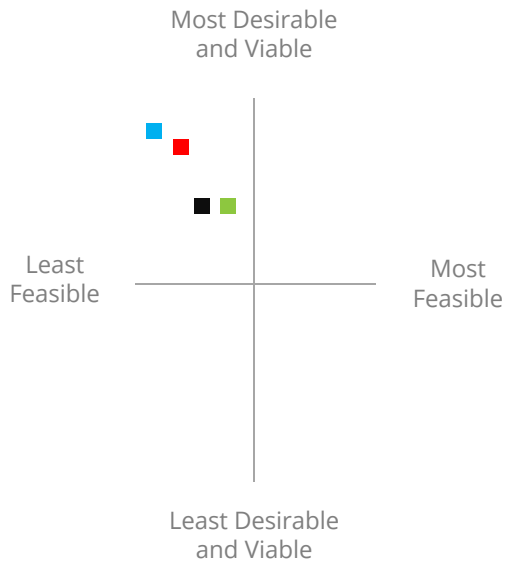


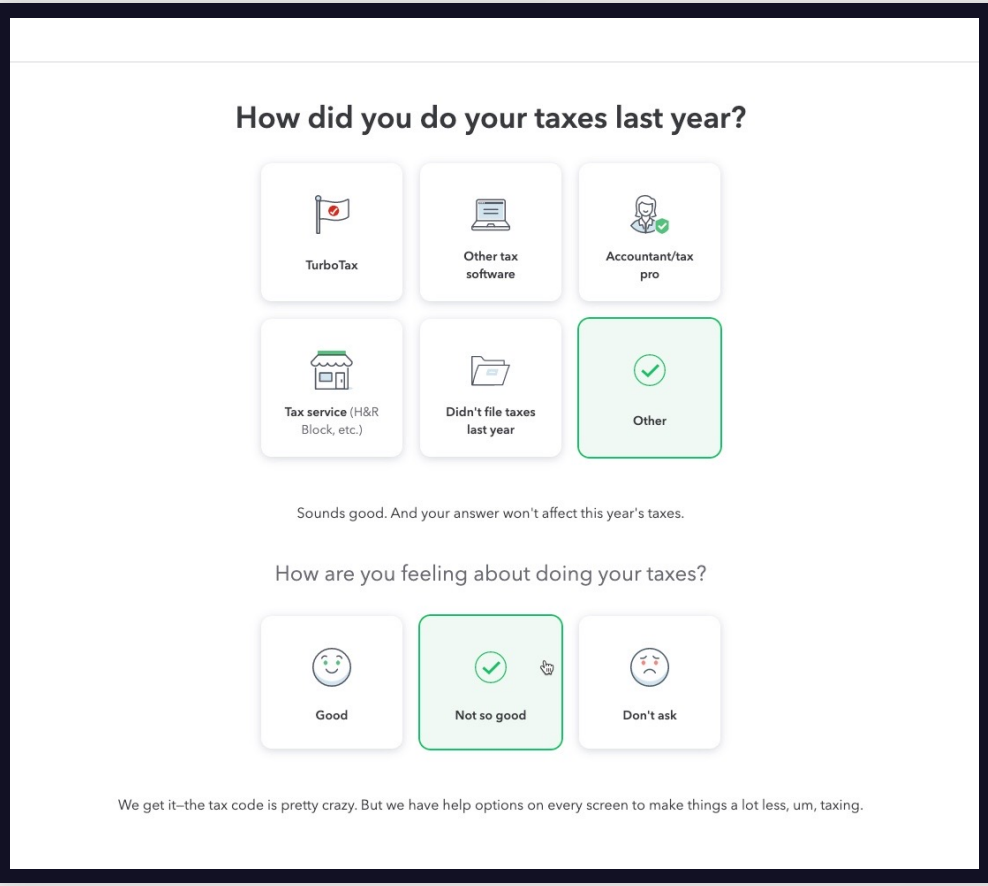
BASIC INFO/ IMPORT

FOCUS	OPPORTUNITY	PRIORTIZATION MATRIX
Users without W-2 forms	Partner with a source that could provide W-2's or other forms directly vs. having the user import to drive new starts.	
Document Upload	Allow users to upload as many forms as they have. Provide a document repository in My Account.	
Personalized experience	Provide dynamic feedback to encourage users in the process. Align more with Fed-needed info to create a tailored experience.	
Personalization	Acknowledge & celebrate big life changes and maybe offer upsells as a "resource”.	

BASIC INFO/ IMPORT

FOCUS

- Users without W-2 forms
- Document Upload
- Personalized experience
- Personalization



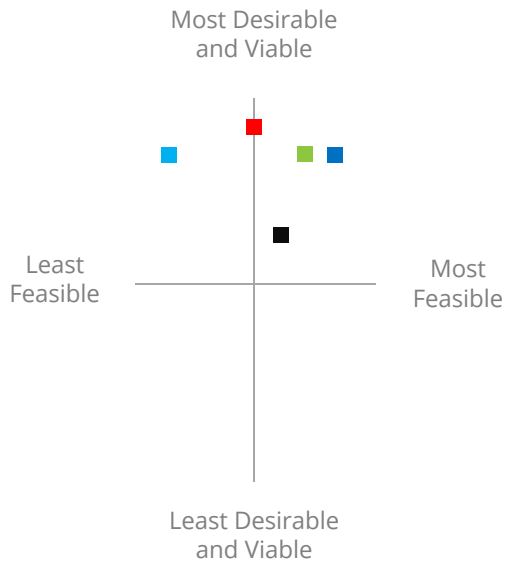
TurboTax provides dynamic feedback to encourage users in their flow.

TaxAct can do the same and in addition align more with Federal-needed information to create a tailored experience.

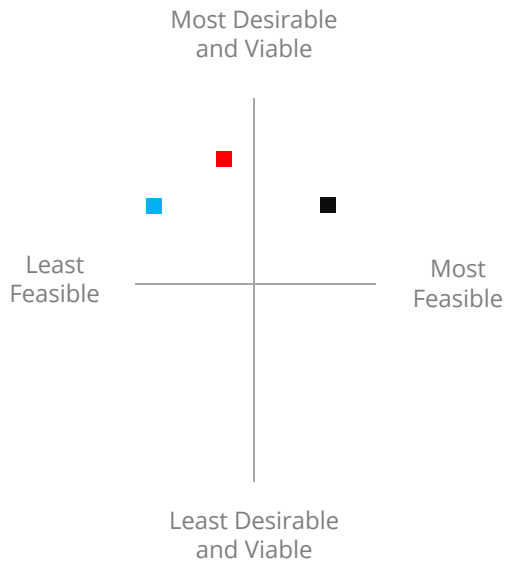
FEDERAL

FOCUS	OPPORTUNITY
Price transparency	HRB's price widget notifies the user when a change in the fee occurs. Make fees applied more discoverable.
Customer guidance	Better guidance creates greater product-attachment and gives user-confidence. Inform users on what's next.
Personalized upgrades	How do we sell ourselves vs our competitors with upgrades. Make upgrades feel less "forced" and tailored to the user.
Streamline content	25% of forms are reusable. Establish a consistent UI patter for forms that are simple, scalable and reusable.
Help offerings	TurboTax offers unobtrusive approach to help. We can define placement for chat and what triggers Help vs Xpert help.

PRIORTIZATION MATRIX



FILING STEP

FOCUS	OPPORTUNITY	PRIORTIZATION MATRIX
Ancillary products	Pitch the right ancillary product to the right users rather than everyone. Ex: Pitch RT to users that have a refund vs users who owe.	
Year-round engagement	Introduce ancillary personalized year-round ancillary products. Would need to go through research discovery etc.	
Upsells	TaxSlayer offers a bundle for almost 2-for-1. We can test the effectiveness of similar design pattern across our upsells.	

FILING STEP

FOCUS

- Ancillary products
- Year-round engagement
- Upsells

Defend. Protect. Restore.

Get **Audit Defense** and **SecurelyID** for only **$44.00**

Audit Defense

Complete defense and representation in the case of an IRS audit for 3 years.

~~$49.00~~ Value

Show details

SecurelyID

A complete identity theft monitoring protection and restoration solution for 1 year.

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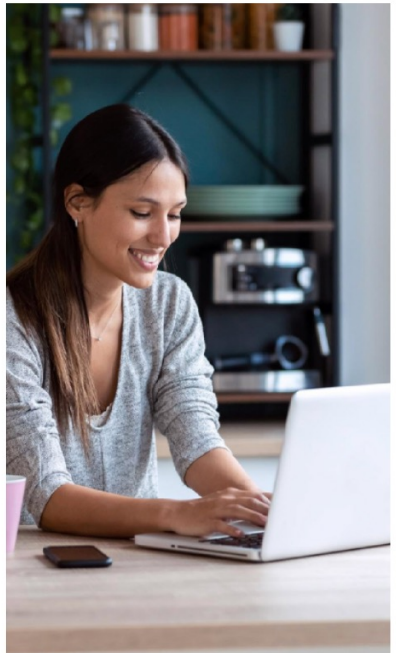
Now only

$44.00



Take advantage of 50% savings when you bundle these top products

All-Inclusive

- **Federal Filing**
  Access to all our online forms and schedules to file your federal return (Form 1040)
- **State Return**
  File one state return
- **Refund Transfer**
  Pay nothing up front by subtracting your TaxAct software fees from your refund
- **E-File Concierge**
  Personalized help to track your e-file status and fix a rejected federal return
- **Audit Defense**
  An audit professional will deal with the IRS for you

Learn more about All-Inclusive

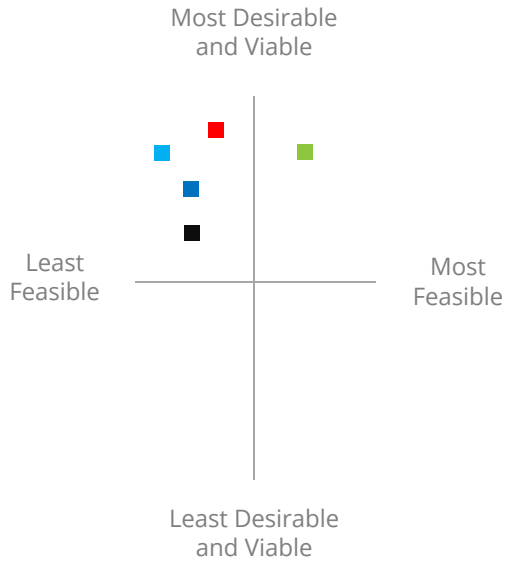
Bundle & Save

$134.95 ~~$279.75~~

*All-Inclusive is a collection of select products and services that may be used to enhance your DIY tax preparation and filing experience. This offer does not include Xpert Help, additional state(s), or a tax professional preparing a return on your behalf. 50% savings based on a la carte pricing. Final price, including added

YEAR-ROUND ENGAGEMENT

FOCUS	OPPORTUNITY	PRIORTIZATION MATRIX
Tax Pro Help	Partner with Avantax, to offer financial advice year-round on a subscription-based platform.	
Tax Plan Savings	Help users build their financial goals with ties to tax plan savings.	
TaxAct Notifications	Customize notification with TRI. Send users a countdown of days left to invest in order to increase their refund or offset a gain.	
Discounts	Offer an incentive for customers to pay for filing earlier than in season (discount)	
Tax Fitness Pal	Allows user to set goals, input receipts and track progress on goals. We can mark anything that can be written-off and offer suggestions.	



OPTIMIZE

UX & TECH DEBT

The intent is to highlight areas within the TaxAct experience where we can make improvements and track them. Below are links to each Miro board.

1. Shopping & Auth
2. Basic Info / Import
3. Federal
4. Filing Step

NEXT STEPS

NEXT

1. Chat with Rick Holden to valid opportunities against customer feedback.
2. Meet with the experience teams and decide which opportunities are relevant to take as business case.